IPL Auction Analysis — Who Was Overpaid?

One-page insight memo | Selected 19-player sample | 2025 auction prices and 2025–2026 performance

Business question

Which selected players delivered the strongest and weakest batting or bowling output relative to their 2025 auction price, and who should franchises monitor for a future auction?

Three numerical insights

Area	Finding
2025 batter value	KL Rahul: 546 runs at ■14 crore = **39.00 runs per crore** (highest). Rishabh Pant: 269 runs at ■27 crore = **9.96 runs per crore** (lowest).
2025 bowler value	Trent Boult: 22 wickets at ■12.5 crore = **1.76 wickets per crore** (highest). T. Natarajan: 1 wicket at ■10.75 crore = **0.09 wickets per crore** (lowest).
Season movement	Ishan Kishan increased from 354 to 602 runs (**+248**); Bhuvneshwar Kumar increased from 17 to 28 wickets (**+11**). Using 2025 prices as a fixed reference, 2026 ratios were 53.51 runs/crore for Ishan and 2.70 wickets/crore for Kagiso Rabada.

Recommendation

Build a future-auction watchlist around **Ishan Kishan** (602 runs in 2026), **Kagiso Rabada** (29 wickets in 2026), and **Marcus Stoinis** (216 runs and 2 wickets in 2026). Treat these as statistical candidates only; confirm availability, fitness, role fit, expected price and franchise requirements before bidding.

Method and limitations

Cricsheet ball-by-ball JSON was filtered to 2025 and 2026, aggregated by player and season, and joined to a selected 2025 auction-price list using player-name mapping. Batters/wicketkeepers are compared using runs per crore; bowlers using bowler-credited wickets per crore, with economy as supporting context; all-rounders retain separate batting and bowling measures. Python/Pandas performs processing, SQLite SQL performs analysis and validation, and Streamlit/Plotly presents the dashboard.

Limitations: the sample contains 19 selected players, not the full league. The 2026 reference ratios use 2025 sold prices, not 2026 auction prices. Simple ratios do not adjust for matches played, batting position, overs, injuries, role, team context or auction demand. Lowest relative value is not proof of objective overpayment.